

Developer Dashboard

Version history

What changed in releases 5.25 through 5.34

Repository-backed summary • 30 September 2026

Scope. This document summarizes the ten version entries from 5.25 to 5.34 using the repository’s changes file and commit history. It distinguishes runtime changes from delivery/report corrections, so a version that updates evidence is not mistaken for a new feature.

The release sequence covers three broad themes: standalone runtime packaging and removal of the PAX compiler; correction and verification of Problems 21–23; and a security floor for CLI help rendering (Problem 24). The versions are not all equal-sized feature releases: several are deliberately narrow follow-up or evidence-correction releases.

At a glance

Version	Date	Primary purpose	Kind of change
5.25	30 Sep 2026	Preserve correct Perl module source paths in standalone runtime packaging	Packaging fix; Problem 21/22 validation
5.26	30 Sep 2026	Remove PAX compiler and compiled execution workflow	Architecture / feature removal; Problem 23
5.27	30 Sep 2026	Harden blank-container browser test compatibility while excluding stale PAX artifacts	Release-test stabilization
5.28	30 Sep 2026	Ensure stale generated PAX outputs cannot enter source distributions	Distribution hygiene
5.29	30 Sep 2026	Replace premature Problem 23 status with verified archive/image results	Delivery evidence correction

Version	Date	Primary purpose	Kind of change
5.30	30 Sep 2026	Complete the Problem 21–23 delivery report	Documentation / evidence
5.31	30 Sep 2026	Correct report to reflect the pushed 5.30 release and 8.0/10 Scorecard	Report correction; governance follow-up
5.32	30 Sep 2026	Correct Problem 21–23 report release labels and retain Scorecard caveat	Report correction; governance follow-up
5.33	30 Sep 2026	Require patched Pod::Text 6.1.1+ for CLI help and tighten isolated dependency audit	Security hardening; Problem 24
5.34	30 Sep 2026	Finalize dependency-audit guards and keep release-gate assertion checkout-only	Security/release-gate follow-up

Release details

5.25 — Preserve module source identity in standalone packages

Standalone runtime expansion could encounter a compiled or excluded module at a path before the usable Perl source copy. The earlier candidate could mask the eligible source, causing the wrong copy to be mapped into the runtime payload. This release preserves the dependency scanner's known source path, avoids re-adding duplicate module entries, and maps PAX-owned module paths relative to their real import root. Regression coverage was added for collision and layout cases. The release entry also records completion validation for Problems 21 and 22; it is not itself the implementation of all those problems.

Source: Changes 5.25 • Problem 21–22 validation • Git work around 5.25 included commits 23981132 and related packaging fixes.

5.26 — Remove PAX from the supported runtime

This is the main architectural change in this range. The vendored PAX compiler, self-compilation cache, public PAX CLI command, private helper staging, and compiled-binary release workflow were removed. Interpreted Perl became the single supported CLI execution path. Docker regressions cover the removed integration. The blank-container browser assertion was also made tolerant of Chromium's generic 401 page or equivalent HTTP failure while still ensuring bootstrap guidance and login content are not leaked.

Source: Changes 5.26 • Problem 23 • Git commit bb14a6fe.

5.27 — Stabilize blank-environment browser checks

The release notes record exclusion of stale generated `pax-output` artifacts from source distributions. They also make the outsider-browser assertion portable across Chromium's generic authentication error page and an equivalent response failure. The security assertion remains strict: bootstrap guidance and login UI must not be disclosed to an unauthenticated outsider.

Source: Changes 5.27 • Primarily packaging/test robustness; follows the PAX removal.

5.28 — Keep stale compiler output out of source archives

This focused packaging release again explicitly excludes old generated `pax-output` artifacts. This matters after PAX removal because a developer's local generated binary must not silently reappear in the source distribution and undermine the interpreted-only package design. It is a distribution hygiene fix, not a new user-facing command.

Source: Changes 5.28 • Git packaging follow-up in the 5.28 release history.

Release details (continued)

5.29 — Report verified Problem 23 delivery state

The previous report had been left at an in-progress stage. This update replaced it with verified archive and Docker image results. The important distinction is that 5.29 records completed delivery evidence; the functional PAX removal landed in 5.26.

Source: Changes 5.29 • Git commit 6b9f5faf (final delivery report).

5.30 — Consolidate Problems 21–23 evidence

The report was expanded to state expected outcomes, Docker reproductions, root causes, current Git references, and explicit delivery status for Problems 21, 22, and 23. It also clearly kept Problem 20 aggregate coverage paused, matching the separate-workstream boundary. This was evidence and documentation work rather than a new runtime feature.

Source: Changes 5.30 • Git commit 6b9f5faf, followed by report corrections.

5.31 — Correct status and Scorecard reporting

This release corrected the delivery report so it reflected the already-pushed 5.30 release and the actual live Scorecard result of 8.0/10. Remaining governance actions were recorded rather than claiming the score was perfect. Problem 20 coverage remained paused. This is a transparency correction: 8.0/10 is not the same as an all-checks-passing result.

Source: Changes 5.31 • Git commit fe14ecf9 and related report work.

5.32 — Fix release labels and preserve the outstanding caveat

Another report correction aligned Problem 21–23 release labels with the actual release sequence and retained the observed 8.0/10 Scorecard result plus unresolved governance actions. It continued to document the Problem 20 pause. It should be read as a correction to the historical record, not as a new feature release.

Source: Changes 5.32 • Git commit fe14ecf9.

5.33 — Security floor for CLI help rendering

Problem 24 added a dependency requirement: CLI help rendering now requires Pod::Text 6.1.1 or later,

with the isolated dependency audit checking the fixed module path and version. CI audit step classification was corrected, and a specific CPANSA advisory was guarded without conflating it with CPAN::Audit's separate Pod::Man version mapping. The changelog explicitly kept Problem 20 aggregate coverage paused.

Source: Changes 5.33 • Problem 24 • Git commit 1e93111d.

5.34 — Close the Problem 24 release-gate follow-up

The final version in this range completed the Problem 24 dependency/audit work. The release-gate assertion was placed in the checkout-only metadata test so the packaged distribution suite does not require the intentionally unshipped `.github` directory. The isolated dependency guard continues to enforce the Pod::Text security floor. Problem 20 remained paused and separate.

Source: Changes 5.34 • Git commit 1e93111d; repository commit at time of preparation was f56aedc2, which is a separate Problem 20 coverage checkpoint.

How to read this sequence

- **Functional centerpiece:** 5.26 removes PAX and restores one interpreted Perl execution model; 5.25 fixes module source selection in standalone payload construction.
- **Packaging hardening:** 5.27–5.28 prevent stale generated compiler files from contaminating distributions and make an authentication check portable without weakening its security expectation.
- **Record accuracy:** 5.29–5.32 progressively correct and substantiate delivery reporting. They should not be counted as four separate runtime capabilities.
- **Security / dependency enforcement:** 5.33–5.34 make the patched Pod::Text minimum and corresponding CI/release checks explicit.
- **Separate paused work:** Problem 20 repository-wide coverage work was expressly not completed by these releases.

Source of truth and caveat. Version summaries above follow the checked-out changes entries dated 29–30 September 2026. Commit IDs are shown where the current history ties a focused problem to a commit; some version entries are corrective releases with their own intervening commits, so the release notes are the authoritative feature summary.